

Chapter 21: Letters

A few days after Feng Yue received the divorce agreement with Yan Lin, she returned to the small villa to pack her things and prepare to move. Her house at Songhe Bay had been completely cleaned up, though Lady Feng had insisted on finding people to help her clean and organize during the process.

Actually, Feng Yue didn't need to move at all. Later, Yan Lin's private lawyer had contacted her.

In the end, Yan Lin hadn't planned to let Feng Yue leave with nothing. She intended to transfer this small villa and several profitable subsidiaries under Yan Corporation to Feng Yue's name, and even proposed paying her a substantial monthly alimony on the grounds of Feng Yue's illness.

But in the end, Feng Yue only accepted the small villa and returned everything else. Her reason for keeping the villa wasn't nostalgia, but because she couldn't bear to part with the roses¹ she had carefully tended in the greenhouse.

The reason for not continuing to live here was also simple. There were too many memories here - good ones, bad ones, from her previous life, from this life. If Feng Yue wanted to live a new life, the first step had to be moving away from here.

Liu Ma packed her belongings one by one into boxes. As if suddenly remembering something, Feng Yue stood up and walked toward the master bedroom.

The master bedroom was pitch black, with curtains tightly drawn so that not a ray of sunlight could penetrate. Feng Yue reached out to pull open the curtains, and bright sunlight finally poured into this bedroom that had been unoccupied for several days.

Following her memory, Feng Yue went to the walk-in closet and from an inconspicuous corner, pushed aside the clothes piled on top and took out a wooden box.

Feng Yue opened the box. Inside was a neat stack of envelopes. The envelopes bore no signatures, but were sequentially marked with the numbers "One, Two, Three... Eleven."

The envelopes all looked different, but you could see the love their writer had poured into them.

These eleven letters she had started writing from the year she began liking Yan Lin. In her previous life, before she died, she had also handed over the twelfth one, but that one was hastily written in the hospital and didn't look as exquisite as the others.

Feng Yue instinctively wanted to open one of the letters, but her movements stopped when she reached the seal.

These eleven letters contained her unreserved love for Yan Lin, but now it was obvious these things no longer had any meaning.

Things without meaning should be thrown away. Better not to leave herself with any lingering attachments.

Feng Yue took those letters and walked out of the bedroom.

Liu Ma had finished packing everything for Feng Yue, and the people Feng Yue had brought had also loaded everything into the car. Now they were just waiting for Feng Yue to come downstairs so they could leave.

"Madam, everything has been loaded into the car."

"Thank you, Liu Ma." Feng Yue smiled. "But you don't need to call me Madam anymore. Yan Lin and I no longer have any relationship."

Liu Ma sighed and nodded: "Miss... Feng."

Feng Yue smiled slightly: "Liu Ma, thank you for taking care of me these past few years. Please... help me with one last thing."

As she spoke, Feng Yue handed all eleven letters to Liu Ma, saying with a relaxed expression: "Please burn all these things."

Liu Ma looked at the items in her hands. Although she didn't know what they were, she could tell from Feng Yue's expression that these were probably things the Madam had once treasured greatly.

She nodded and solemnly accepted those items: "Yes, Miss Feng."

Feng Yue's eyes curved with a smile upon hearing this.

After saying goodbye to Liu Ma, Feng Yue got into the car that had been waiting in the courtyard. Soon the car disappeared from Liu Ma's sight.

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When Yan Lin returned home, there was a fire basin² set up in the courtyard burning something, and you could see a small plume of thick smoke from far away.

Yan Lin pushed open the door and got out of the car, her gaze falling on the objects burning in the fire basin - things that appeared in her memory. Yan Lin was stunned for a moment, then rushed over.

Then, amid Liu Ma's exclamations, Yan Lin reached bare-handed into the burning fire basin to rescue those eleven letters.

"Miss! Are you alright? Oh my, what are you doing!"

The scalding flames burned Yan Lin painfully, but she could no longer care about such things.

The rescued letter remains lay quietly on the courtyard lawn. Some were more than half burned, while others had only a tiny bit of their corners charred.

Liu Ma was still concerned about Yan Lin's injuries on the side, but Yan Lin just stared blankly at those letters, then asked: "Liu Ma, where did these come from?"

"These things were given to me by Madam before she left, asking me to burn them all." Liu Ma said. "Miss, let's go inside and apply some medicine. Your fingers should be burned - they're all red."

Yan Lin turned a deaf ear to Liu Ma's concerned words, only staring fixedly at the letters that had nearly been destroyed lying on the lawn.

They were almost identical to the letters in her memory. Even though some were nearly completely burned, Yan Lin quickly recognized their sequence.

In her previous life, she had gotten the twelfth letter from Lady Yan first, then went looking for the previous eleven.

She had only read these letters once, and only dared to read them once.

It was precisely after reading these letters that Yan Lin developed the habit of needing a night light to sleep.

But now, she hadn't even had time to look at the familiar contents inside, and these letters had nearly perished in flames.

Feng Yue had personally thrown her own feelings from more than ten years into this fire basin.

Without hesitation, resolutely and decisively.

Yan Lin ignored Liu Ma's words about applying medicine and went straight into the second-floor study with the pile of remains.

Yan Lin carefully arranged these letters one by one on her desk, then reached out to brush away the burned ashes, keeping only the unburned portions.

The letters were kept in envelopes, and at this moment Yan Lin didn't even have the courage to open the envelopes.

She found several books from the bookshelf and silently placed the letters between them. Perhaps one day she would have the courage to reopen these incomplete letters.

After doing all this, Yan Lin sat back in her chair as if all her strength had been drained.

After a while, Yan Lin called Mo Yixu.

The other end answered quickly: "Hello, President Yan."

"Assistant Mo, find someone to come to the villa later to help me move."

Mo Yixu was somewhat surprised and asked: "Yes, President Yan. Where should we move to?"

Yan Lin rubbed her temples and said wearily: "Move to Jinshan Villa³ for storage."

Jinshan Villa District was far from the city center, taking about two hours to commute to the company. If President Yan was going to move there, he would need to reschedule his work hours. Mo Yixu thought silently.

"Do you need someone to clean up the house there?"

"No need, I won't be living there. Just find a hotel near the company."

"Yes, President Yan."

Yan Lin came with empty hands but left carrying several books.

Back in the car, the burned areas began to ache faintly.

The driver had also seen Yan Lin reach bare-handed into the fire, so he asked with concern:

"Should President Yan go to a pharmacy to buy medicine?"

Yan Lin glanced at the burned areas and shook her head indifferently: "No need, go to the old mansion."

When Yan Lin returned to the old mansion, she first placed the books containing the letters in her study, then buried herself in her room.

It wasn't until Lady Yan came upstairs to call her for dinner that she discovered Yan Lin lying in bed, burning with fever and delirious.

It turned out that after drinking with Fu Sixue that night, Yan Lin hadn't rested much, constantly dealing with company affairs. Actually, those matters didn't need urgent attention, but Yan Lin just didn't want to let herself be idle.

Several consecutive days of high-intensity work, combined with the psychological shock of discovering the burned letters today, caused Yan Lin's body to collapse.

This illness came fiercely, and the old mansion didn't quiet down that entire night.

Perhaps it was also Feng Yue's condition that had triggered Lady Yan's nerves - any sign of trouble with Yan Lin's physical condition made her as jumpy as a startled bird⁴.

When Wei Yuran arrived at the old mansion, Yan Lin was running a fever and talking deliriously.

Yan Lin's fever wouldn't break and she needed an IV drip⁵. When Wei Yuran finished handling everything and took her temperature again, he finally heard clearly what she was saying.

"A-Yue... A-Yue... I miss you so much..."

"You finally survived..."

"Those letters... I've kept them safe, and also, the twelfth one..."

Wei Yuran had no intention of prying into his employer's private affairs, but hearing this now, he couldn't help feeling somewhat melancholy.

He had worked for the Yan family for several years and had watched these two people's journey together. He knew how attentive Feng Yue had been to Yan Lin in the early years.

But it was also during that time that he saw through the fact that these two wouldn't last long.

Miss Feng's fearless devotion and Yan Lin's unequal response destined them to separate.

At that time, he thought Feng Yue wouldn't be able to persist for long, but now it seemed Feng Yue's love for Yan Lin exceeded his imagination.

But it ended there nonetheless.

The two still couldn't escape the final outcome of separation.

Because of Yan Lin's sudden high fever, their original plan to go to the civil affairs bureau⁶ to get their divorce certificate had to be postponed again.

However, Feng Yue didn't care what methods Yan Lin used to delay. In any case, she had signed, and Yan Lin couldn't escape.

Ever since Feng Yue went with her parents to examine at the municipal hospital where her father's director friend worked, she received caring phone calls from her mother every day.

Morning, noon, and evening - three times a day, more punctual than her taking medicine.

Feng Yue knew her mother was worried about her health, so she was never impatient. In her previous life, she had seen her mother cry too many times because of her. She didn't want her mother to shed tears again because of her illness.

Actually, a few days ago Lady Feng had disagreed with Feng Yue living alone and insisted on keeping her at home for proper care.

It was only after Feng Yue's repeated persuasion that Lady Feng finally agreed. However, Lady Feng still came to Feng Yue's house every few days to cook for her.

And that's how Feng Yue's video-making activities were exposed.

Footnotes:

¹ **Roses (月季):** These are specifically Chinese roses (*Rosa chinensis*), which are different from Western roses but are often translated as "roses." They're significant because Feng Yue's name contains the character "月" (moon), connecting her identity to these flowers.

² **Fire basin (火盆):** A traditional Chinese metal container used for burning materials, often used for warmth or ceremonial purposes like burning incense or paper offerings.

³ **Jinshan Villa (锦山别墅):** A fictional upscale residential area. "Jinshan" literally means "brocade mountain," suggesting a luxurious, scenic location.

⁴ **Startled bird (惊弓之鸟):** A Chinese idiom referring to someone who becomes extremely nervous or jumpy after a traumatic experience, like a bird that's been shot at and now fears the sound of a bowstring.

⁵ **IV drip (挂水):** In Chinese medical practice, intravenous fluid therapy is commonly used for fever treatment, more so than in some Western countries.

⁶ **Civil affairs bureau (民政局):** The government office in China where marriages and divorces are officially registered and finalized.